



Executive Threat Intelligence Brief

OpenCTI Threat Intelligence Sprint – Board Overview

January 2026

Executive Summary

Cyberinfiniti Ltd, Team 8 operated as a dedicated Threat Intelligence function within a simulated organizational environment, leveraging OpenCTI as the central intelligence management platform enriched with live, community-driven intelligence through the AlienVault OTX connector. The assessment delivers actionable intelligence by correlating real-world indicators, adversary behaviors, and observed attack patterns with established analytical frameworks, including the Diamond Model of Intrusion Analysis, the Cyber(Global) Kill Chain, and the MITRE ATT&CK framework.

Key Objectives

Profile the cyber threat landscape affecting the organization's industry sector

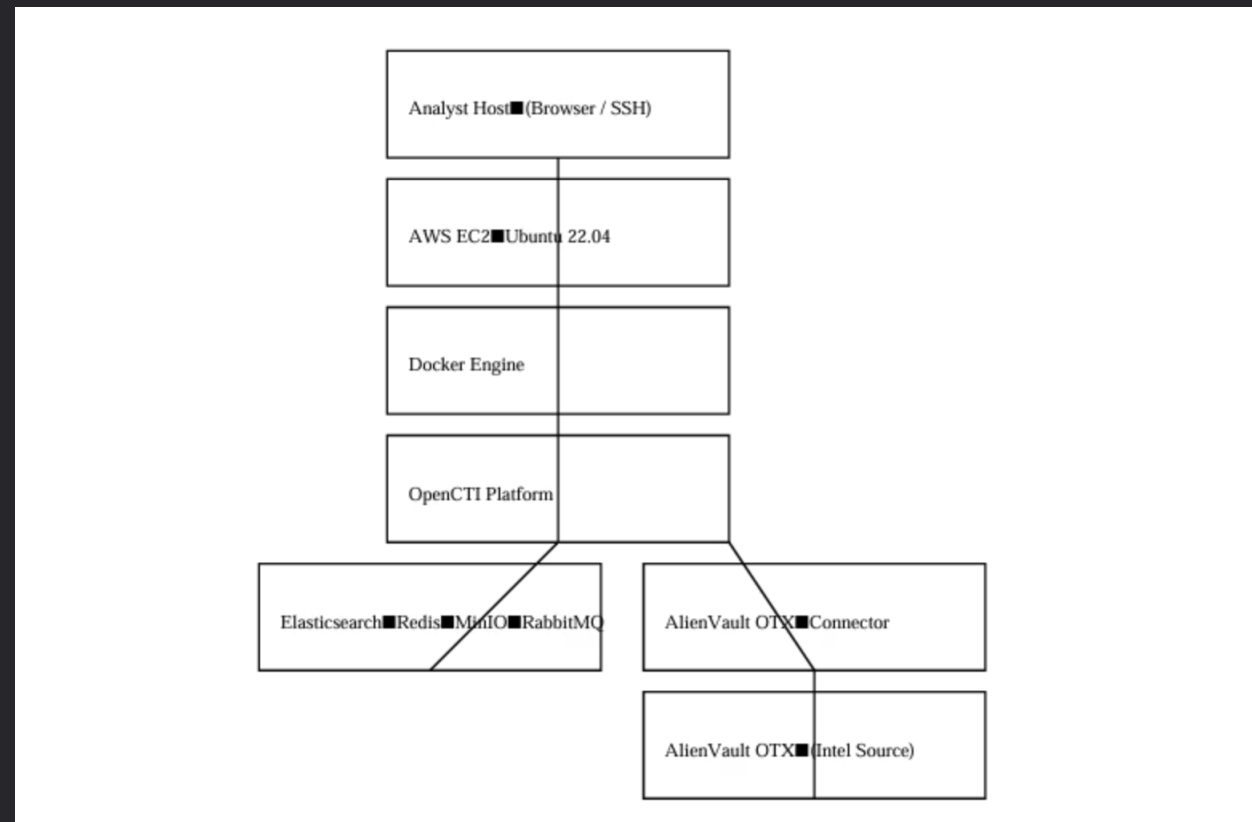
Assess country-level cyber threats impacting headquarters and regional operations

Identify recently targeted victims and analyze associated threat actors and campaigns

Investigate politically motivated threat actors involved in recent high-impact activity

Translate technical findings into clear, executive-level intelligence to inform risk-based decisions

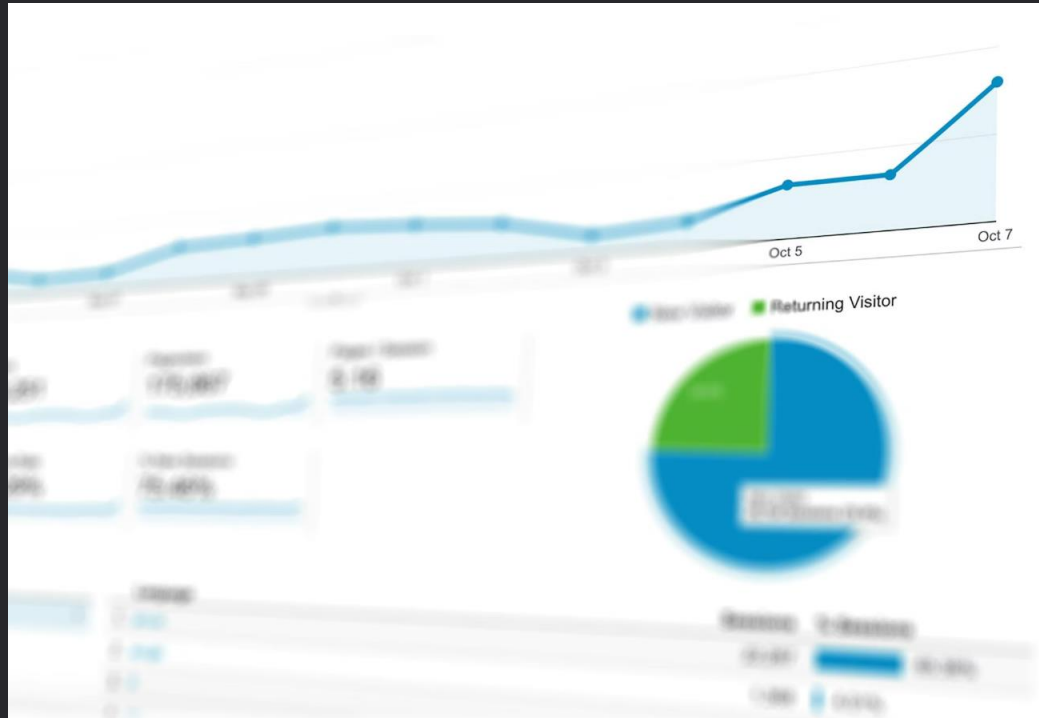
OpenCTI Platform Setup & Architecture (AWS)



Executive & Technical Takeaways

- The AWS-based OpenCTI deployment successfully simulated an enterprise-grade CTI platform
- Docker-based architecture enabled modular intelligence ingestion and processing
- Secure network controls minimized cloud exposure risk
- AlienVault OTX integration enriched analysis with real-world, community-driven intelligence
- The architecture supports continuous expansion and future automation

Assessment Scope & Method



Advanced Threat Intelligence Platform

Comprehensive analysis using OpenCTI with live AlienVault OTX enrichment



MITRE ATT&CK Alignment

Tactical threat mapping



Kill Chain Analysis

Attack progression tracking



Diamond Model

Adversary behavior patterns

Sector Threat Landscape – (IT & MSSPs Sector)

Ransomware Dominance

Double extortion tactics create operational and reputational risk

State-Sponsored Espionage

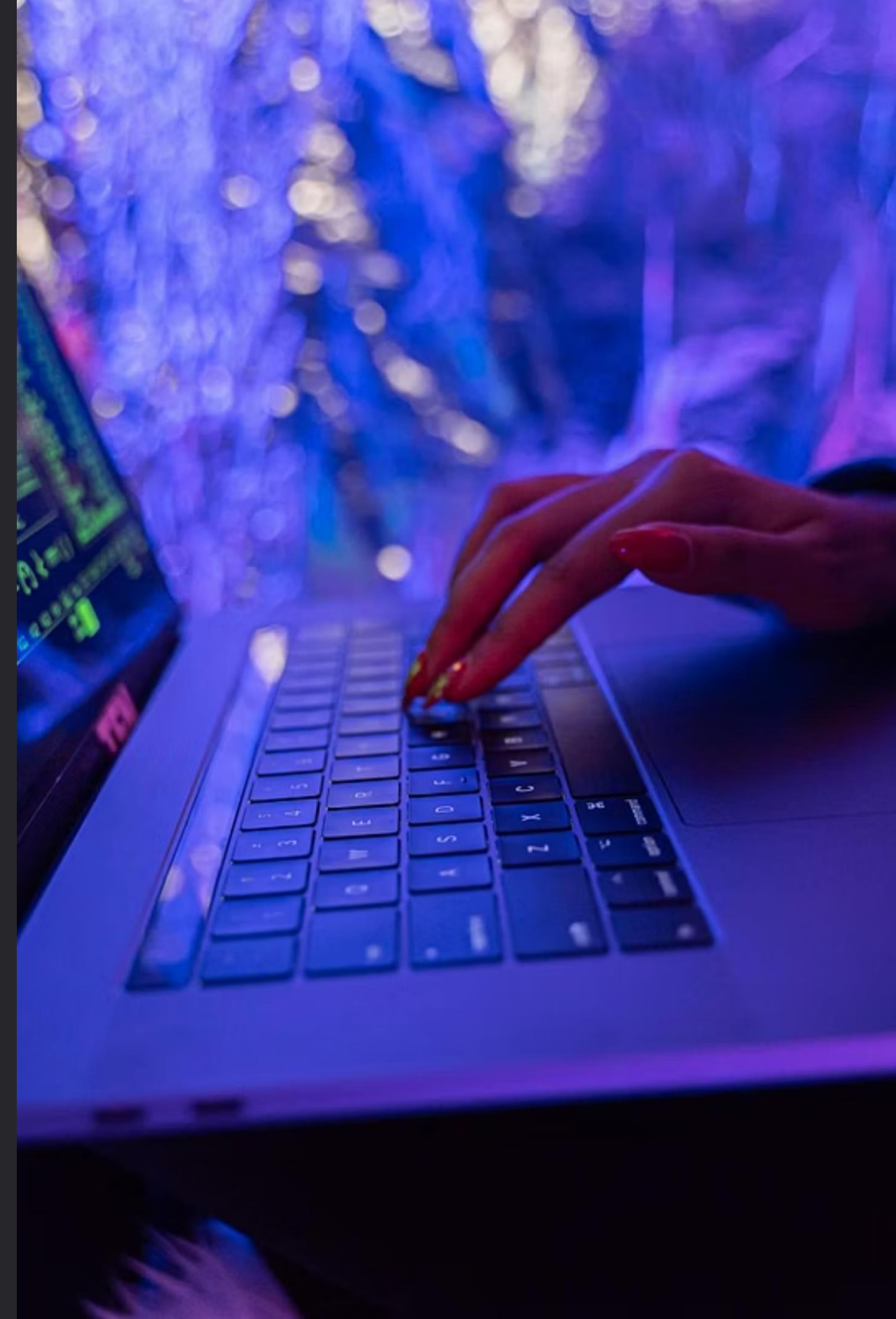
Trusted IT providers targeted for supply chain compromise

Credential Theft

Enables lateral movement across enterprise environments

Stealth & Evasion

Legitimate tools weaponized to bypass traditional defenses

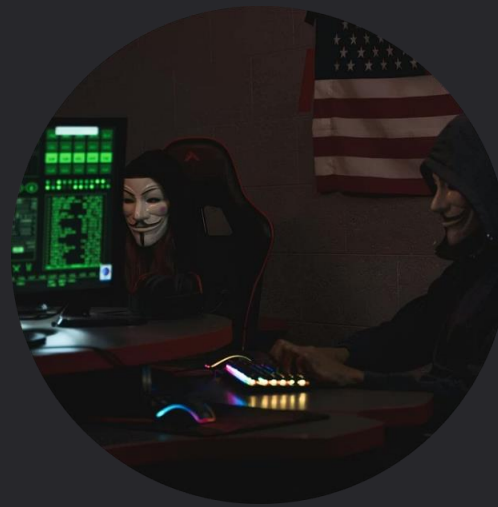


Key Threat Actors Impacting the Sector



Akira Ransomware

Financially motivated, enterprise-focused double extortion campaigns



APT17

Long-term espionage operations targeting intellectual property and data



POLONIUM

Intelligence-driven campaigns leveraging cloud-based command infrastructure

Top Threats Targeting Nigeria

Active Threat Groups

Hilalrat (UNC788)

Financial motivation:
ransomware + data
theft

Hoplite / APT38

Lazarus Group:
state-sponsored
financial operations

Attack Patterns

- Spear phishing campaigns
- Credential abuse and privilege escalation
- Lateral movement within networks
- Data exfiltration and extortion

Recently Targeted Victims – Key Patterns (Last 3 months)

Government Institutions
Espionage and strategic access for intelligence collection

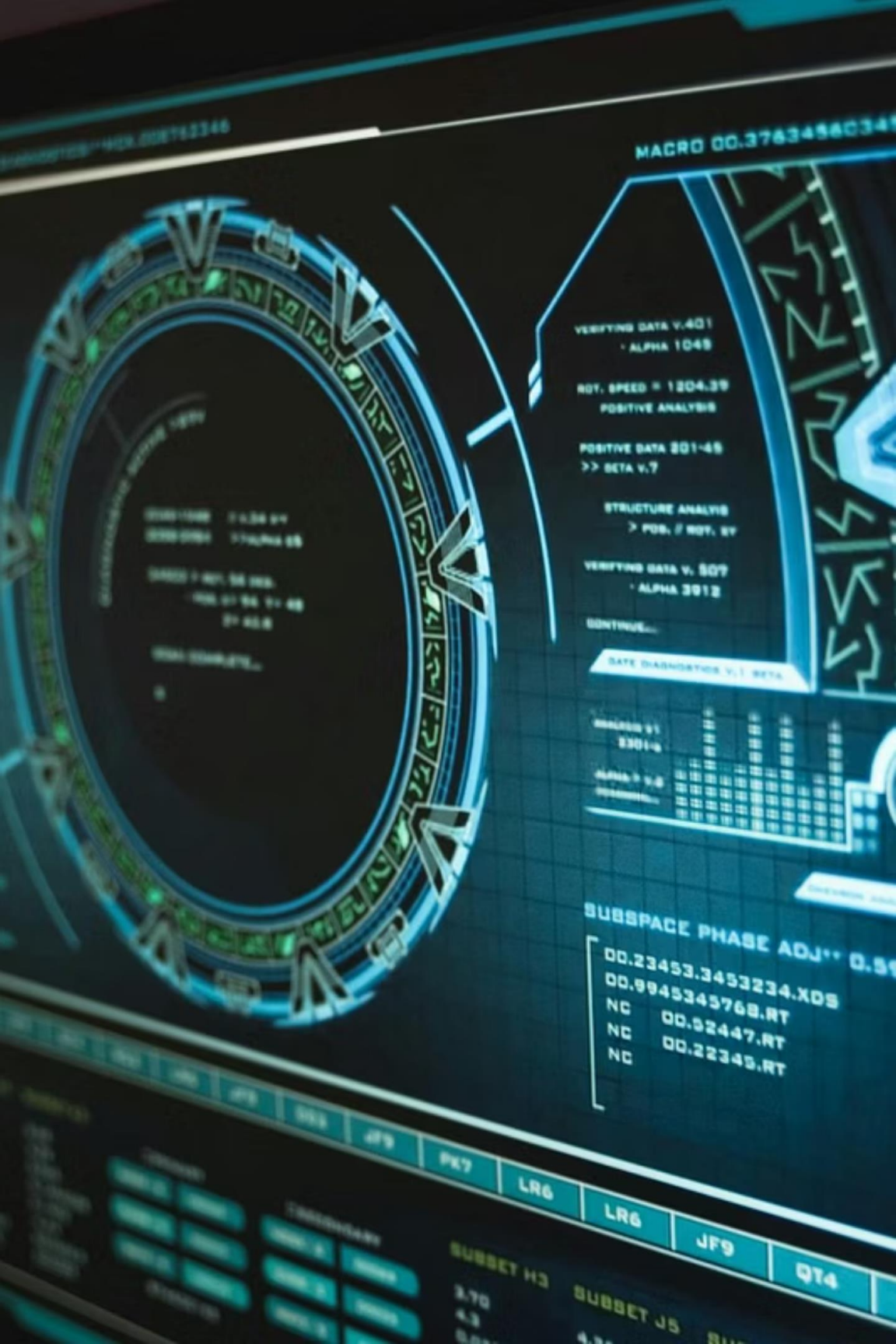
- Threat Group:**
- Primary Tool: PS Exec (S0029)
 - Associated Threat Actor: Chafer
- Tactics:**
- Spear phishing
 - Credential theft
 - Long-term persistence

Healthcare Organizations
Sensitive data theft and operational disruption

- Threat Groups:**
- Threat Group: Tropic Trooper
 - Associated Actor: Pirate Panda
- Tactics:**
- Double extortion
 - Data exfiltration
 - Service disruption

Defense Sector
Intelligence gathering and geopolitical insight

- Threat Groups:**
- Threat Group: Tropic Trooper
 - Associated Actor: Pirate Panda
- Tactics:**
- Destructive malware
 - Critical infrastructure targeting
 - Supply chain compromise



Politically Motivated Threat Actor – Sandworm



Russia-Aligned APT

Disruption-focused operations, not financial gain

- **Critical Infrastructure Targeting**
Energy and utilities primary focus
- **Destructive Malware**
Operational and reputational damage
- **Geopolitical Motivation**
Aligns with Russian strategic objectives

Executive Assessment

Sandworm represents a high-impact, politically motivated cyber threat capable of executing destructive operations against critical national infrastructure. While not always aimed at immediate service disruption, its campaigns are designed to signal capability, undermine confidence, and exert geopolitical pressure.

Organizations operating within energy, government, or critical infrastructure sectors, particularly in NATO-aligned regions, must assume Sandworm as a credible threat actor. Proactive intelligence integration, strong defensive controls, and preparedness for destructive attack scenarios are essential to mitigating risk from this adversary.

Key Findings

Persistent Ransomware Threat

Ransomware activity remains a significant risk, capable of causing operational downtime and data compromise

Active State-Sponsored Espionage

Nation-state actors continue to conduct intelligence collection and pre-positioning within targeted networks

Rise in Politically Motivated Destructive Attacks

Wiper malware and sabotage-focused campaigns are increasingly used to disrupt critical services during geopolitical tensions

Widespread Credential Compromise

Abuse of valid accounts is a common initial access technique across observed threat campaigns

Increased Targeting of Critical Sectors

Critical infrastructure, government, healthcare, and defense sectors remain high-value targets due to strategic and symbolic importance

Detection Strategies & Controls

Detection Strategies

- Monitor OpenCTI for emerging indicators and campaigns
- Correlate OTX pulses with SIEM and EDR telemetry
- Apply behavioral detection aligned with MITRE ATT&CK

Preventive Controls

- Network segmentation and least-privilege access
- MFA enforcement and credential monitoring
- Regular threat intelligence updates and simulations

Strategic Recommendations



Enhance Ransomware Readiness

Implement regular offline backups, ransomware-focused incident response playbooks, and recovery testing to reduce operational impact



Strengthen Monitoring for Advanced Threats

Improve detection of lateral movement, persistence, and living-off-the-land techniques associated with state-sponsored actors



Prepare for Destructive Attack Scenarios

Integrate wiper and sabotage attack simulations into business continuity and disaster recovery planning



Harden Identity and Access Management

Enforce MFA, monitor privileged account usage, and deploy continuous authentication monitoring to reduce credential abuse



Adopt Sector-Specific Threat Intelligence

Leverage intelligence platforms such as OpenCTI to track adversaries targeting critical sectors and inform proactive defense measures

Conclusion

Executive Outlook:

Organizations that treat cyber threat intelligence as a strategic capability, embedded into governance, decision-making, and resilience planning will be better positioned to anticipate, absorb, and recover from high-impact cyber events in an increasingly volatile threat landscape.

The threat landscape demands proactive, intelligence-driven defense strategies. Organizations must strengthen identity security, enhance detection capabilities, and treat threat intelligence as a strategic business function to maintain resilience against evolving adversaries.

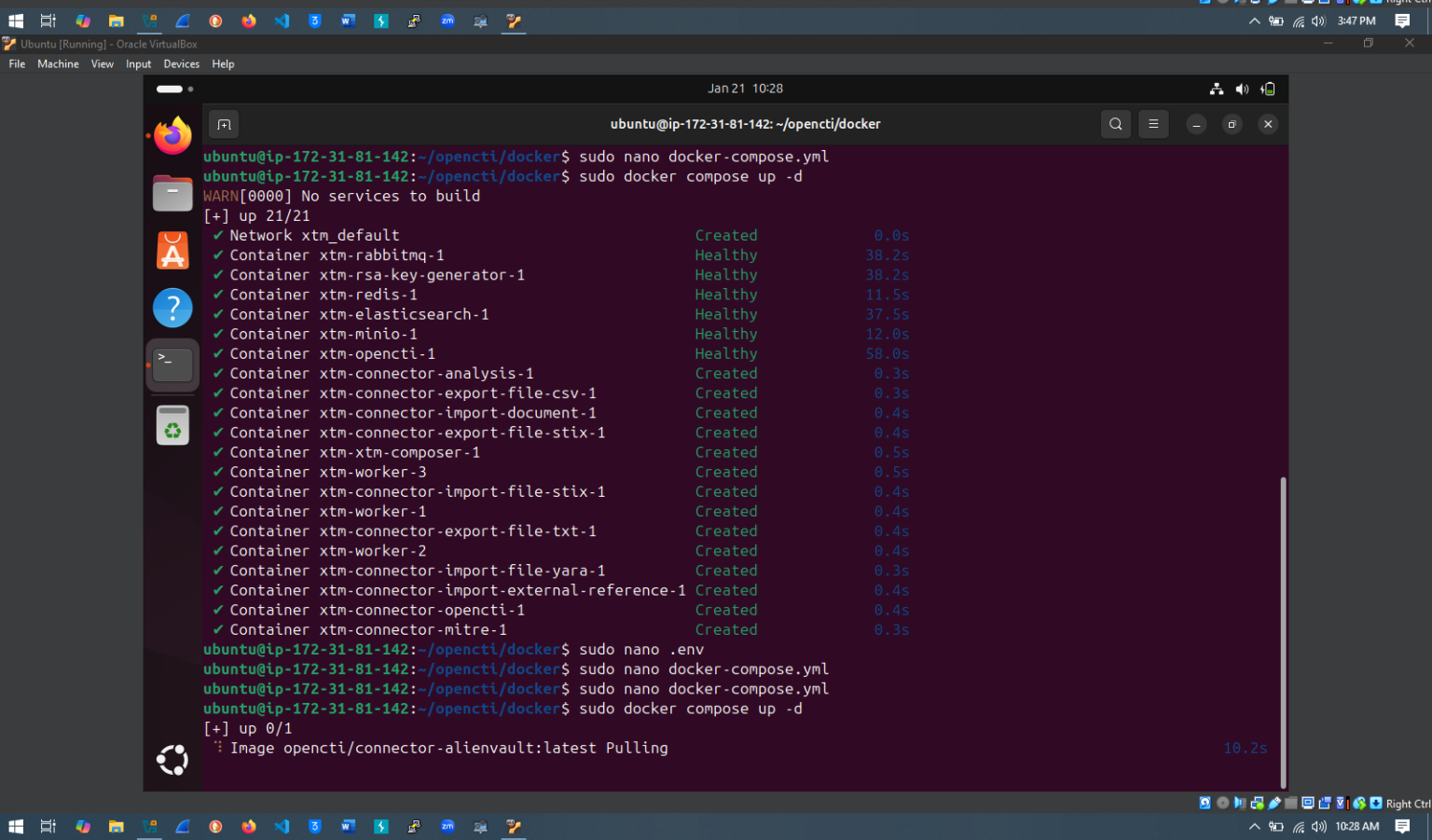
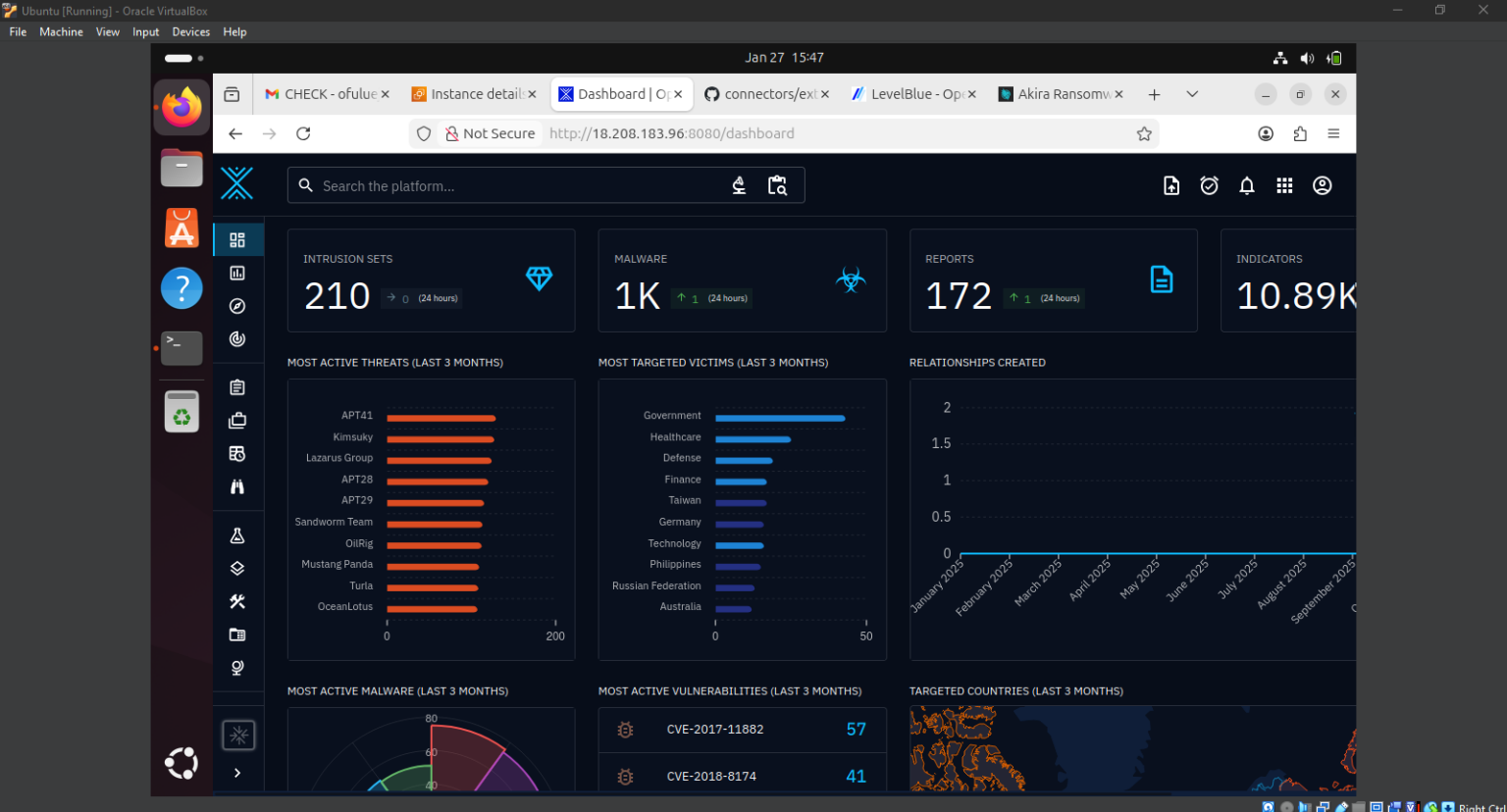
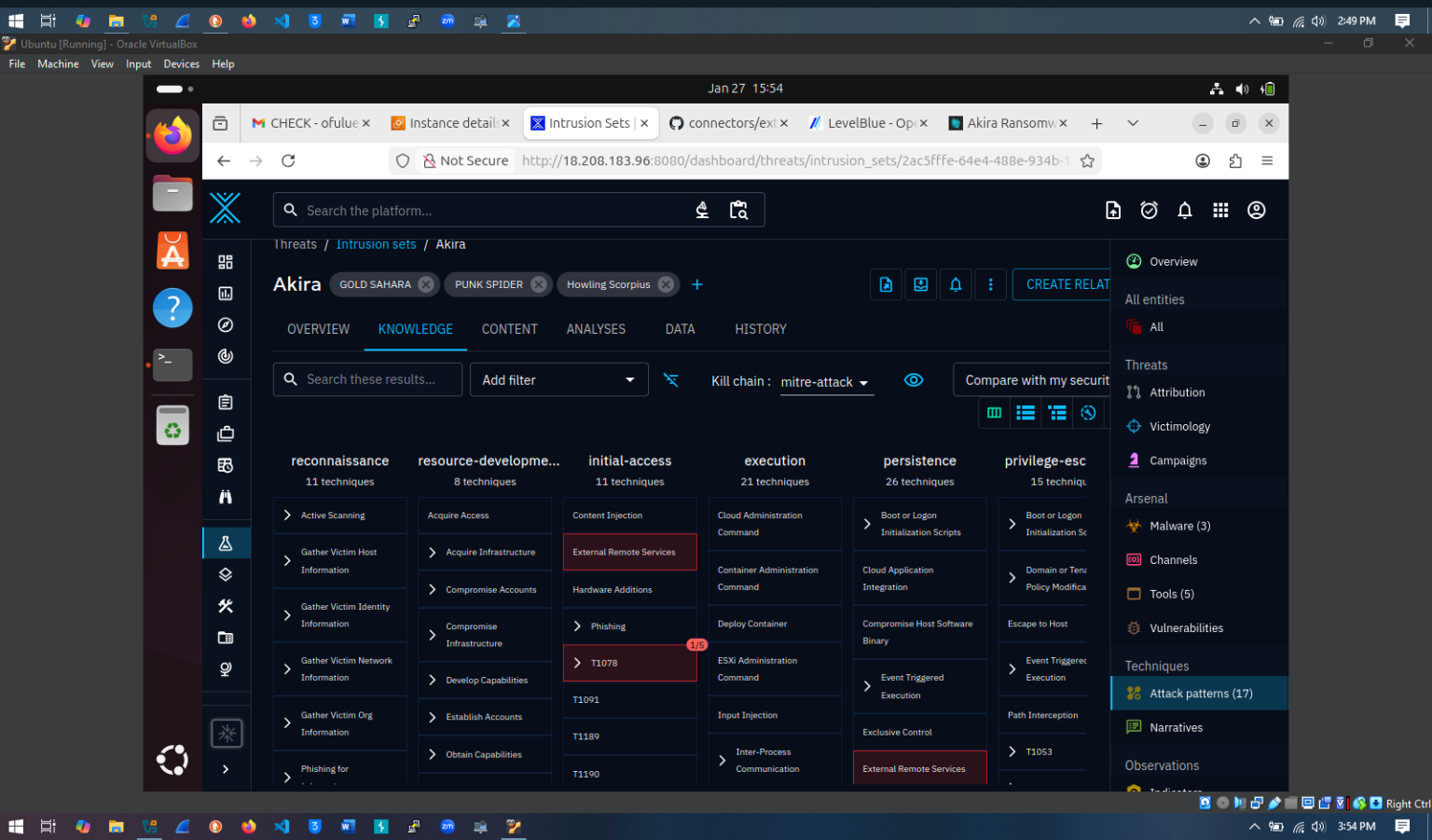
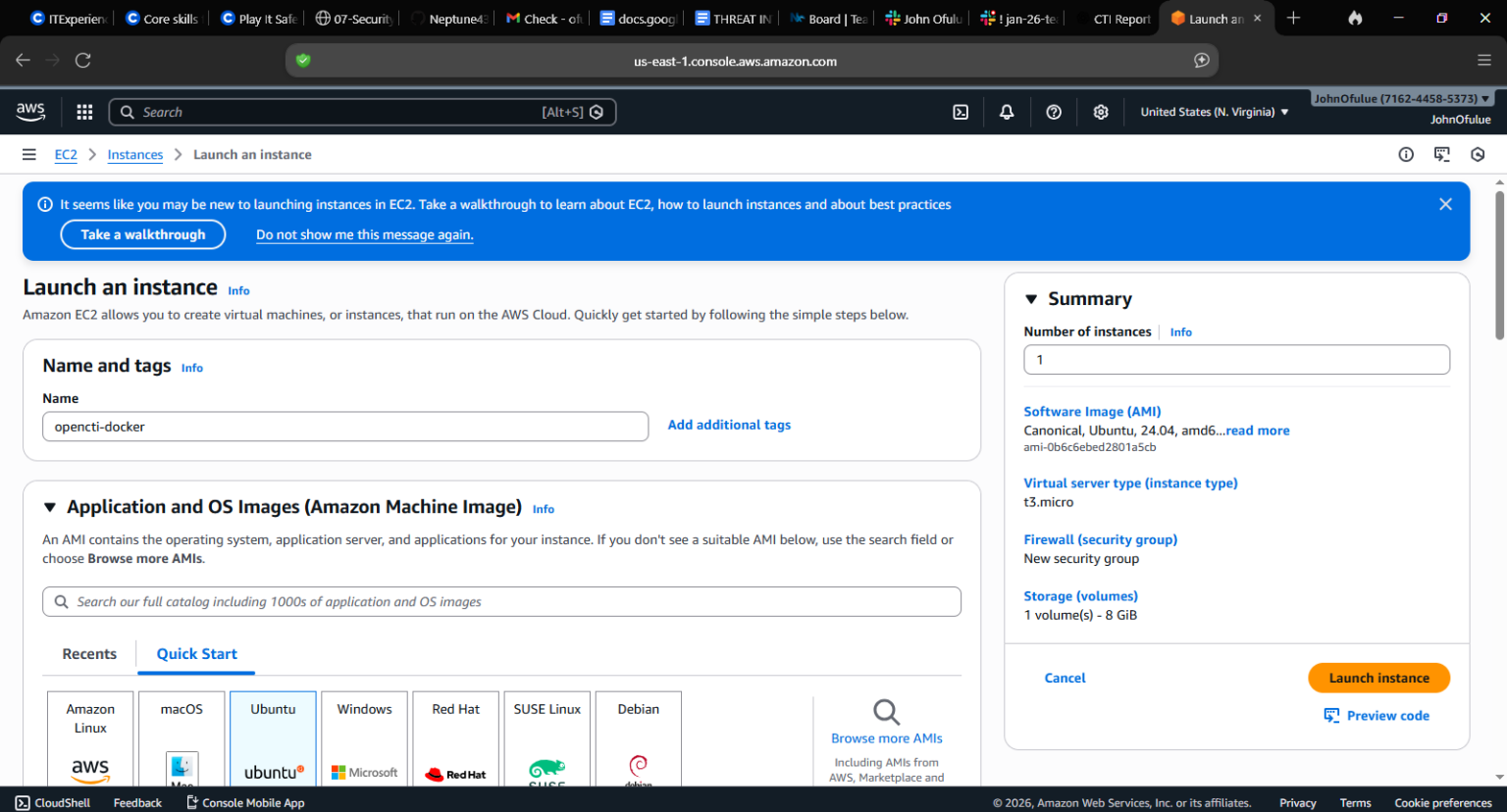
Lessons Learned

Threat intelligence is most effective when aligned with business context

Automation and enrichment significantly improve analyst efficiency

Executive-ready reporting is critical for informed decision-making





Thank You

Questions & Discussion

Team 8 - Cyberinfiniti Ltd

Threat Intelligence Sprint

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